

Design Review Report

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Teaching Videos

List each teaching video you watched. For each one, write a real takeaway. What concept clicked for you? What surprised you or challenged an assumption you had? What impressed you about how your teammate demonstrated something? Take this seriously. Your teammates put real effort into these videos to teach you something you did not study yourself.

Video

I watched **Esther's**'s video on **Pure CSS Icons**.

Takeaway

What stood out to me most was learning how many different icons can be created using only CSS borders and pseudo-elements without relying on SVGs or icon libraries. I didn't fully understand how a border triangle worked until I saw the instructor demonstrate changing the width and height to zero and how the borders formed four triangles. It also clicked for me how `::before` and `::after` can create multiple visual elements from a single HTML element, especially in the animated hamburger menu. I also liked the explanation of when CSS icons are appropriate and when SVGs are the better choice. That connects directly to my own work because I just built an accessible SVG icon system for my practice site. It helped me understand that simple UI icons can sometimes be created with CSS, but reusable or more complex icons are better implemented as SVGs for flexibility and accessibility.

Code Reviews

Review at least two teammates' portfolio repositories. Look at their actual code for Choose Topic pages you did not build yourself. Each design review you should choose different teammates to review so that over the course of the semester you cycle through everyone on your team.

Review

I reviewed **Esther**'s code for their **Resume** page.

What You Found

One thing I noticed that the video didn't fully show was how organized the project was overall. The HTML and CSS were cleanly structured, which made it easy to follow how each icon was built from simple CSS techniques. I also liked that the examples progressed from simple shapes to a more complex animated hamburger icon, making it easy to understand each step. I didn't notice any broken styles or functionality while testing the page. Everything worked as expected, including the animation and accessibility features. One thing I want to learn from is how the pseudo-elements (`::before` and `::after`) were used so effectively to create multiple parts of an icon from a single HTML element. I didn't find any issues that needed to be reported to my teammate.

Review

I reviewed **Harrison Merrill**'s code for their **View Transitions API** page.

What You Found

One thing I noticed in the code that the video did not fully show was how much attention was given to browser support and accessibility. The JavaScript checks whether `document.startViewTransition` is supported and falls back to a normal instant content swap, so the page still works in unsupported browsers. I also liked that the demo includes a reduced-motion option and organizes each topic in one JavaScript object, which keeps the detail content easy to manage.

I did not find any broken links or major layout problems while testing the live page. The list-to-detail buttons worked, the Back to List button returned correctly, and the theme control was clearly labeled for screen readers. The one small thing I noticed was a typo in the visible example text where `document. startViewTransition()` has an extra space after the period, but it does not affect the actual functionality. I would mention that minor typo to my teammate, but overall the demo was well organized and gave me a useful example of progressive enhancement that I could apply in my own work.

Portfolio Preview

How Did the Portfolio Review Go?

After looking through a few classmates' portfolios, I noticed that most of them followed a similar overall layout and design, which makes sense since we have been building on the same practice site throughout the semester. One thing that stood out to me was how some students used icons and spacing to make their pages easier to scan. I also liked seeing the different color palettes and typography choices that gave each site its own personality. Overall, everyone's sites looked polished, and I picked up a few small design ideas that I may use in future projects.

Anything Before Unit 7?

Before Unit 7, I want to make a few small improvements to my portfolio by refining the spacing around my icons and sections and making sure everything is as polished and consistent as possible across all pages.